

Questions and Answers: The Kansas City Earnings Tax

On the Ballot for Renewal - Kansas City, MO - April 7, 2026

(For Informational Purposes Only)

What is the earnings tax?

The earnings tax (“e-tax”) is a 1% tax on income earned by residents of Kansas City and nonresidents who work within the city limits. That revenue is used to fund city services enjoyed by every resident of Kansas City, including first responders (firefighters, paramedics/EMTs, and police officers), trash pickup, road maintenance and pothole repair, and snow removal. Historically, about half the revenue generated by the e-tax is paid by people who live OUTSIDE Kansas City.

Because it is a tax on income, **retired residents or those who are not working do not pay the e-tax. Social Security, disability, and unemployment income are not subject to the e-tax.**

Will voting “yes” raise my taxes?

No. The earnings tax has been in place in Kansas City since 1963. A “yes” vote will renew the tax at its current rate, without raising taxes for anyone.

How do KCMO residents benefit from the e-tax?

The e-tax funds critical city services, including first responders (firefighters, paramedics/EMTs, and police officers), trash pickup, anti-illegal dumping efforts, road maintenance and pothole repair, snow removal, and more, without higher sales or property taxes. Kansas City has made significant investments in improving city services, especially in public safety and road repair, that have been made possible because of the earnings tax. Every resident of Kansas City benefits from these services, and from the lower property and sales tax rates that the e-tax makes possible.

Can we fund these services with other funding sources?

No. Failed renewal of the e-tax would result in cuts to city services, including first responder layoffs, increased emergency response times, and cuts to trash pickup, road maintenance, and snow removal. Replacing the revenue generated by the e-tax would require significant increases in sales and/or property taxes, affecting every person in Kansas City, and even those increases would not replace the funding we would lose without the e-tax.

Who supports the renewal of the e-tax?

E-tax renewal is supported by a coalition of community support, business leaders, labor organizations, and elected officials, including the Greater Kansas City Chamber of Commerce, the Heavy Constructors Association, Fire Fighters Local 42, Mayor Quinton Lucas, the KC Civic Council and more. For an up-to-date list of community leaders and organizations who have endorsed the e-tax renewal, visit together-kc.com.

Why is the e-tax being put up for a vote?

Missouri law requires that the e-tax be put up for a renewal vote every five years. The e-tax has been in place since it was first approved by Kansas City voters in 1963.

Is the e-tax legal?

Yes. The city attorney’s office has determined that the e-tax is legal, and it has been in place since 1963.

When is the election?

The e-tax renewal will appear on the ballot in the April 7, 2026, election. Qualified voters may vote absentee in person beginning on March 24.

Learn More: together-kc.com

Paid for by Together KC, Dan Kopp, Treasurer.